

Crypto Tracker - Expo Go & Firebase Setup Guide

Introduction

This guide walks through setting up the Crypto Tracker React Native project using Expo Go and integrating Firebase on a fresh laptop.

1. Install Prerequisites

Node.js & npm

Install Node.js (v18+ recommended) which includes npm.

macOS (Homebrew): `brew install node`

Windows: Download and install from <https://nodejs.org>

Verify installation:

`node -v`

`npm -v`

Git

macOS (Homebrew): `brew install git`

Windows: Install Git from <https://git-scm.com>

Verify: `git --version`

Expo CLI

`npm install -g expo-cli`

Expo Go App on Phone

Install Expo Go from Google Play Store (Android) or App Store (iOS).

2. Clone the Repository

`git clone https://github.com/Narmatha-Thangarasu/crypto-tracker.git`

`cd crypto-tracker`

3. Install Project Dependencies

`npm install`

4. Add Environment Variables / API Keys

If the app requires an API key or Firebase config, create a .env file in the root of the project:

API_KEY=your_api_key_here

FIREBASE_API_KEY=your_firebase_api_key

FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN=your_project.firebaseio.com

FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID=your_project_id

FIREBASE_STORAGE_BUCKET=your_project.appspot.com

FIREBASE_MESSAGING_SENDER_ID=your_sender_id

FIREBASE_APP_ID=your_app_id

5. Set Up Firebase in Project

1. Go to <https://console.firebase.google.com/> and create a new project.
2. Add a Web App and copy the Firebase config.
3. Install Firebase SDK in your project:

npm install firebase

4. Initialize Firebase in your project (e.g., in firebase.js):

```
import { initializeApp } from 'firebase/app';
```

```
import { getAuth } from 'firebase/auth';
```

```
const firebaseConfig = {  
  apiKey: process.env.FIREBASE_API_KEY,  
  authDomain: process.env.FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN,  
  projectId: process.env.FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID,  
  storageBucket: process.env.FIREBASE_STORAGE_BUCKET,  
  messagingSenderId: process.env.FIREBASE_MESSAGING_SENDER_ID,  
  appId: process.env.FIREBASE_APP_ID,  
};
```

```
const app = initializeApp(firebaseConfig);  
export const auth = getAuth(app);
```

6. Start the App

npx expo start

- A browser window will open with the Expo Dev Tools.
- Scan the QR code with the Expo Go app on your phone.
- The app will load directly on your device.

7. Troubleshooting Tips

- Ensure your phone and laptop are on the same Wi-Fi network.
- Restart the terminal or Expo Dev Tools if QR scanning fails.
- Clear Expo cache: **expo start -c**

8. Summary Checklist

1. Install Node.js, npm, Git, and Expo CLI.
2. Install Expo Go on your phone.
3. Clone the repo.
4. Install dependencies (npm install / yarn).
5. Add .env with API keys and Firebase config.
6. Set up Firebase in the project.
7. Start the app with Expo and scan QR code with Expo Go.